NAFED

An Institution of the Members, by the Members, for the Members



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> "There is but one mode by which man can possess in perpetuity all the happiness which his nature is capable of enjoying, - that is by the union co-operation of all for the benefit of each, said"
>
> **Robert Owen,**
> the father of Cooperative movement.

This realization which emerged some where in the middle of the 18th century marked the beginning of an era which transpired into one of the biggest people's movement in the form of Co-operative Movement.

It didn't take much time for the movement to reach India. India, being an agrarian economy, also embraced the Co-operative model, the principles of mutual-aid, concern for communities which are inherent in this model best suited for addressing the issues of rural credit, marketing of agriculture produce, and community welfare.

Although the Co-operatives are institutions built upon open and voluntary membership and democratic management, the role of the Government becomes important for supporting these institutions for realizing their objectives and at the same time maintaining the spirit of these institutions.

The National Agriculture Co-operative Marketing Federation (NAFED), is one of the oldest National level apex marketing federation established in 1958 with a view to provide marketing assistance to the agriculture marketing co-operatives and also help its marketing co-operatives in the other agricultural operations. Since the member co-operatives of NAFED draw membership from the farmers, therefore the hierarchical three-tier structure consisting of Primary Cooperatives at the bottom, State Level Cooperatives in the middle and NAFED at the top is best suited for reaching out to the farmers and to extend the benefits to the farmers. This structural advantage also makes NAFED one of the best institutions for implementing the farmer-centric Government schemes.

NAFED is one of the largest procurement as well as marketing agencies for agricultural and horticultural produce, significantly contributing towards making agriculture viable and sustainable for the farmers, thus supporting the rural economy in a big way. NAFED, through its country-wide operations, plays a crucial role in improving the living conditions of farmers and bringing prosperity to the rural economy. At a larger level, NAFED's relentless country-wide agri-related operations ensure food security for the nation and provide efficient market linkages to the farmers.

NAFED undertakes the multifarious activities benefitting the farmers and stakeholders

- NAFED is one of the Central Nodal Agencies of the Government of India for the procurement of Pulses and Oilseeds under the Price Support Scheme (PSS). Whenever the prices fall below the Minimum Support Price (MSP) declared by Government of India, NAFED undertakes procurement of the notified crops of Oilseeds, Pulses and De-husked Coconut, Milling/Ball Copra, etc. at MSP.
- Procurement of Pulses and Onion under Price Stabilization Fund (PSF) scheme of Government of India as one of the Central agencies by creating buffer stocks of said commodities.
- Procurement of Wheat and Paddy at MSP as a State Nodal Agency on behalf of the Food Corporation of India and the State Governments under De-centralized Procurement (DCP) scheme.
- Suppling Milled Pulses to Army, CPMFs and State Governments under PDS, MDM, ICDS welfare schemes.
- As one of the Central Seed Agencies of the Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (DAC&FW), Government of India, NAFED undertakes production, distribution and marketing of certified seed of Pulses, Oilseeds and Cereals under the Seed Mini kit Distribution programme and also against general supplies to various States.
- Undertakes the supply of Agri-commodities like Pulses, Food Grains, Spices, Edible Oils,